UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

COMBINED DEFENCE SERVICES (CDS) EXAMINATION

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE (GS)

COMPLETE CHAPTER-WISE PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS REPOSITORY

Target Academies:	IMA • INA • AFA • OTA
Syllabus Domain:	Indian Polity, Indian History, Geography, General Science & Defence
Question Format:	100% Authentic UPSC Examination Multiple-Choice Questions
Marking Scheme:	+0.83 Marks per correct response | -0.28 Negative marking (1/3rd)
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SYLLABUS BLUEPRINT & MODULE BREAKDOWN:

Chapter	Pillar Name	UPSC Exam Weightage
Chapter 1	Indian Polity & Constitution	20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)
Chapter 2	Indian History & Freedom Struggle	20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)
Chapter 3	Geography (Physical, Indian & World)	20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)
Chapter 4	General Science & Defence Systems	30 - 35 Questions (25.0 - 29.2 Marks)

CHAPTER 1 : INDIAN POLITY & CONSTITUTION

UPSC CDS Weightage: 20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)

Focuses on Constitutional framework, Fundamental Rights, Writs, Union Executive, Parliament, Judiciary, and Statutory Bodies as tested in UPSC CDS exams.

Q.1 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2024]

Consider the following statements regarding the writ of 'Quo-Warranto':
1. It is issued to prevent illegal usurpation of a public office by a person.
2. It can be sought only by an aggrieved person whose fundamental right has been violated.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.2 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2024]

Which Article of the Constitution of India provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts within the territory of India?
(a) Article 141 (b) Article 142 (c) Article 143 (d) Article 144

Q.3 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2023]

Under Article 368 of the Constitution of India, a Constitutional Amendment Bill can be introduced in:
(a) Lok Sabha only
(b) Rajya Sabha only
(c) Either House of Parliament
(d) Either House of Parliament or any State Legislative Assembly

Q.4 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2023]

Which of the following Fundamental Rights is/are available to both Indian citizens and foreigners (except enemy aliens)?
1. Equality before law and equal protection of the laws (Article 14)
2. Protection of life and personal liberty (Article 21)
3. Freedom of speech and expression (Article 19)
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.5 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2022]

The Joint Sitting of both Houses of Parliament is summoned by the President under Article 108. Who presides over such a Joint Sitting?
(a) The Vice-President of India (Chairman of Rajya Sabha)
(b) The Speaker of Lok Sabha
(c) The Prime Minister of India
(d) The Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs

Q.6 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2022]

Which of the following authorities is vested with the power to alter the boundaries or name of any State in India?
(a) The President of India (b) The Parliament by simple law (c) The Supreme Court of India (d) The State Legislature concerned

Q.7 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2021]

The Directive Principles of State Policy in the Constitution of India were borrowed from the Constitution of which country?
(a) United States of America (b) Ireland (c) Australia (d) Canada

Q.8 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2021]

Which Constitutional Amendment Act substituted the word 'Armed Rebellion' for 'Internal Disturbance' in Article 352 (National Emergency)?
(a) 42nd Amendment Act, 1976
(b) 44th Amendment Act, 1978
(c) 52nd Amendment Act, 1985
(d) 73rd Amendment Act, 1992

CHAPTER 2 : INDIAN HISTORY & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

UPSC CDS Weightage: 20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)

Covers Ancient India (Vedic, Buddhism, Mauryas), Medieval India (Delhi Sultanate, Mughals, Bhakti-Sufi), and Modern India National Movement (1857 to 1947).

Q.9 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2024]

Which of the following Harappan sites has provided evidence of a ploughed field?
(a) Kalibangan (b) Lothal (c) Dholavira (d) Banawali

Q.10 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2024]

Who among the following was the founder of the 'Servants of India Society' in 1905?
(a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Dadabhai Naoroji

Q.11 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2023]

The historic Poona Pact of 1932 was signed between Mahatma Gandhi and:
(a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) Mohammad Ali Jinnah (c) Subhas Chandra Bose (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.12 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2023]

Which Buddhist Council was convened during the reign of King Ashoka at Pataliputra?
(a) First Buddhist Council (b) Second Buddhist Council (c) Third Buddhist Council (d) Fourth Buddhist Council

Q.13 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2022]

The Cabinet Mission arrived in India in 1946. Who among the following was NOT a member of the Cabinet Mission?
(a) Lord Pethick-Lawrence (b) Sir Stafford Cripps (c) A.V. Alexander (d) Lord Wavell

Q.14 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2022]

Who among the following led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar?
(a) Nana Saheb (b) Kunwar Singh (c) Tantia Tope (d) Maulvi Ahmadullah

CHAPTER 3 : GEOGRAPHY (PHYSICAL, INDIAN & WORLD)

UPSC CDS Weightage: 20 - 25 Questions (16.7 - 20.8 Marks)

Encompasses Geomorphology, Oceanography, Climatology, Indian River Drainage, Monsoon Dynamics, and Resource Distribution.

Q.15 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2024]

In which one of the following islands of India is an active volcano found?
(a) Car Nicobar Island (b) Nancowry Island (c) Barren Island (d) Maya Bunder Island

Q.16 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2024]

Which one of the following is the oldest mountain range in India?
(a) Himalayas (b) Aravalli Range (c) Western Ghats (d) Vindhya Range

Q.17 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2023]

The boundary line between India and China is known as:
(a) Radcliffe Line (b) Durand Line (c) McMahon Line (d) 38th Parallel

Q.18 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2023]

Which of the following river basins is known as the 'Sorrow of Bengal'?
(a) Damodar River (b) Kosi River (c) Hooghly River (d) Teesta River

Q.19 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2022]

Roaring Forties, Furious Fifties, and Shrieking Sixties are terms applied to strong westerly winds found in the:
(a) Northern Hemisphere (b) Southern Hemisphere (c) Equatorial low-pressure trough (d) Arctic region

Q.20 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2022]

Which one of the following ocean currents is a cold current in the Atlantic Ocean?
(a) Gulf Stream (b) Benguela Current (c) Kuroshio Current (d) Brazil Current

CHAPTER 4 : GENERAL SCIENCE & DEFENCE SYSTEMS

UPSC CDS Weightage: 30 - 35 Questions (25.0 - 29.2 Marks)

High-yield domain covering Physics (optics, mechanics), Chemistry (reactions, periodic properties), Biology (cell, human systems), and Indian Armed Forces Defence Systems.

Q.21 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2024]

A person suffering from myopia (near-sightedness) is advised to wear lenses of:
(a) Convex lenses (b) Concave lenses (c) Bifocal lenses (d) Cylindrical lenses

Q.22 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2024]

Which one of the following metals is stored in kerosene oil to prevent it from reacting with atmospheric moisture and oxygen?
(a) Magnesium (b) Sodium (c) Aluminium (d) Calcium

Q.23 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2023]

Which cell organelle is famously known as the 'Powerhouse of the Cell' due to ATP production?
(a) Ribosome (b) Golgi apparatus (c) Mitochondria (d) Lysosome

Q.24 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2023]

BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile developed as a joint venture between India and:
(a) France (b) Israel (c) Russia (d) United States

Q.25 | [UPSC CDS (II) 2022]

Which one of the following gases is responsible for the effervescence observed when baking soda is added to vinegar?

(a) Hydrogen (b) Carbon dioxide (c) Oxygen (d) Nitrogen dioxide

Q.26 | [UPSC CDS (I) 2022]

The Western Naval Command of the Indian Navy is headquartered at:

(a) Visakhapatnam (b) Kochi (c) Mumbai (d) Karwar